



Puppy Foundations

Premium practice worksheet

PUPPY FOUNDATIONS · LESSON 03

Teach your puppy what to bite instead.

This worksheet helps owners respond consistently to puppy biting, build better toy habits, and prevent rough play from escalating.

TRAINER NOTE

Puppy biting often gets worse with fatigue and over-arousal. Many hard biting moments are really rest and management problems.

START HERE

Dog: _____

Date: _____

Owner: _____

Best reward: _____

1 What success looks like

By the end of this lesson, the owner can redirect biting, protect skin and clothing, and help the puppy settle before mouthing turns frantic.

2 Practice plan

1

Interrupt with a toy

Present a chew or tug toy before the puppy lands on skin or clothes.

2

Pause the fun

If biting continues, quietly stop interaction and reset for a few seconds.

3

Reinforce calm mouth

Reward chewing the right item, licking, or settling after redirection.

4

Watch the pattern

Use naps, decompression, and lower stimulation to prevent the hardest moments.



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3 Supplies and setup

Supplies needed

- ☐ Long tug toy and soft chew toys
- ☐ Stuffed food toy or lick option
- ☐ Baby gate or pen for short resets
- ☐ A lightweight leash or house line

Set up before you start

- ☐ Keep toys within reach in the main puppy area.
- ☐ Plan a calm reset spot for over-tired moments.
- ☐ Notice common triggers such as evening zoomies or moving clothing.

4 Biting and teething log

Date	Trigger	Redirected to	Response	Recovery	Notes

5 5-day practice micro plan

Day 1

Set baseline

Find the easiest version and keep it calm.

Day 2

Repeat wins

Practice the same setup until it looks smooth.

Day 3

Add one tiny step

Add only one small challenge if yesterday

Day 4

Hold or simplify

If your puppy struggled, make today easier.

Day 5

Review notes

Choose the safest next step from your log.



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6 Common mistakes and quick fixes

Common mistakes

- Using hands as toys.
- Trying to wrestle through over-arousal.
- Ignoring nap needs.
- Yelling or physically pushing the puppy away.

If this happens, try this

- If biting spikes at night, add an earlier nap and reduce exciting play.
- If the puppy chases ankles, toss a toy ahead of you before moving away.
- If redirection fails, use a brief calm reset in the pen and try again later.

7 Ready to progress?

- ☐ I can recognize when my puppy is getting over-aroused.
- ☐ I have a plan for redirecting to toys.
- ☐ I reward calm chewing and settling.
- ☐ I know when my puppy needs a rest break instead of more activity.

HOMEWORK

Keep a five-day log of the three most common biting triggers, what you redirected to, and whether a nap or calmer setup helped.

8 Owner reflection

Biggest win: _____

What made it easier: _____

What should I repeat tomorrow: _____

QUESTIONS FOR YOUR FITDOG TRAINER

What should I make easier? _____

What should I practice again? _____

What is the next realistic step? _____